

ALGOL

Stars: White / White Dwarf / Yellow

Known for: Home of the Ahlam's Temple, The Elephant Market in Akhandar, A history of crime

Exports: Ore, industrial goods, chemicals, lumber

Imports: Luxury items, religious goods, foods

"The Demon Star", home to common citizens, laborers and rebels. The planet is known for its heavy industry, deep mines, and vast wastelands. Equally, it's famous for power struggles between Consortium-affiliated rulers, and Firstcome crime families. Rapid industrial expansion has taken its toll on both the planet and its inhabitants, leaving the people divided between company loyalists and rebels.

SYSTEM OVERVIEW

Algol is a system that has attracted people from across the Horizon. From wealthy citizens, to laborers living hand to mouth, to fugitives, many make their homes under its blackened sky. Algol is a system that once faintly resembled the Al-Ardha of legends – a coveted dream for the first colonists. Today, the activities of the Consortium and other companies have shattered the dream. The people of Algol are torn between loyalists and rebels, and the planet has suffered deep wounds from the progress of industry. It has become another version of the Al-Ardha that the Horizon's ancestors were forced to flee so many cycles ago.

ALOGOL-A

Yavan: Algolan Colony.

Ermeru: Agricultural planet and home of Ahlam's Temple.

Algol: The Algolan Homeworld, controlled by the Consortium.

The Cloud Belt: A band of gas and dust, and the last resting place of many wrecked starships.

Taus: A gas giant circled by several habitable moons.

Marakir: A deserted, rocky planet.

Younos: A gas planet featuring the twin pillars of Ifris and Mahari.

RHAAS

Ghul: Rumored to be home to secret slaver bases.

Rhaas-Mohra Mining Station: Co-owned and jointly operated by Hyperion (a Consortium member) and The Free League.

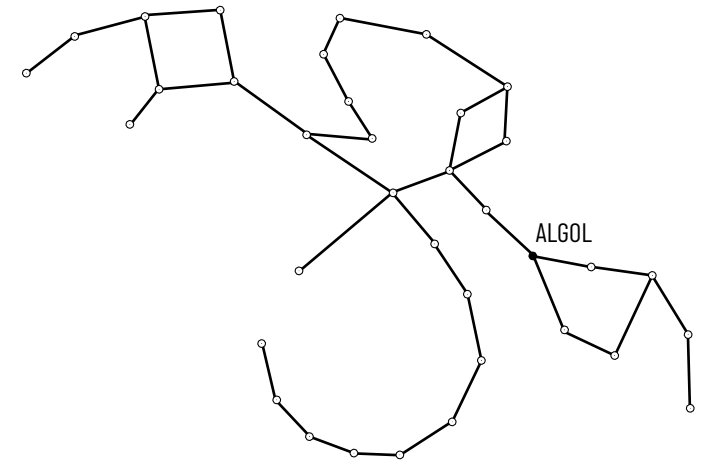
Zabra: The remains of the planet Zabra circle in this orbit.

PERSEI

This white dwarf orbits Algol-A at an angle of 88° off the orbital plane.

CHILDREN OF THE DEMON STAR

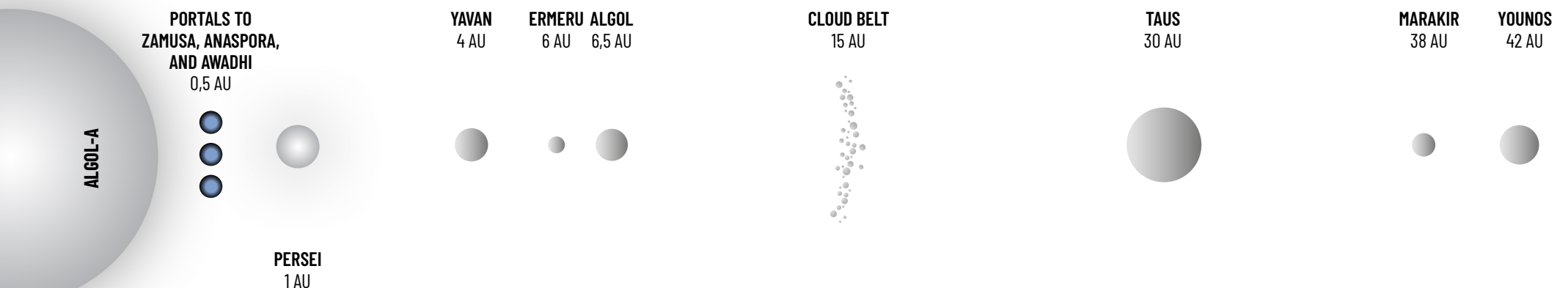
Across the Third Horizon, Algol's reputation reflects its unspoken name: "The Demon Star". It was thought to be a haunted place only visited by the desperate and the greedy. Those colonists were probably aware of the stories, but ignored the system's bad reputation. Algol resembled the Al-Ardha they left behind,



while their ship sensors indicated the system was home to rich concentrations of metals and minerals. Tradition names Algol as the first planet in the Horizon to be settled by the Firstcome. Algolans are proud of the status this confers, and take great umbrage at any suggestion – especially from "Mirans unfit to wipe down an elephant" – that Algol is not the cradle of civilization in the Third Horizon.

The Firstcome settled in the temperate belts on the planet Algol. They quickly set to work, building several cities characterized by architectural wonders, sky towers, and even several iconic temples that are now surrounded by prayer towers.

When the First Portal War raged across the Horizon, Algol was hit hard. Many cities were destroyed during a campaign of orbital



GHUL
4 AU

RHAAS-MOHRA
STATION
6 AU



ZABRA
12 AU



bombardments remembered today as "The Age of Flaming Tears." In the aftermath, The Demon Star took back all that the people had received from it. Hunger, disease, civil war, and death followed and it was during this time that the now infamous Algolan Slavers first appeared.

The arrival of the Zenithians on Algol revitalized the wounded world. Attracted by the same opportunities to exploit the system's metals and minerals but far better organized, the Zenithians rebuilt many of the cities. The Consortium and other companies quickly conquered Algol and The Golden Age of the Zenithians began.

ZENITHIAN GOLDEN AGE

The Consortium was the largest faction on Algol. With birr, grav cranes, and Vulcan might, the corporations of the Consortium seized control of the ruined cities and began extracting the planet's natural resources. Infrastructure was repaired and expanded, but vulgar displays of wealth next to growing shantytowns have become the face of the Consortium on Algol.

The Zenithian Hegemony has also invested heavily in several of the planet's cities through the Algolan community that thrived in the shadow of the Monolith on Kua. Through their Algolan vassals, the Hegemony exercised control over large segments of the workforce around Algol's major cities, despite the fact that the Free League has tried to persuade the workers to join them instead. The Hegemonists themselves seldom visited the planet, relying on Algolans or low-blooded Zenithians to pursue their interests.

Meanwhile, crime families thrived in the shadows, picking up the crumbs left by the Zenithians.

ALGOL TODAY

The Zenithian rule has been broken by the war, allowing the al-Farhat family to rise in power. Nael al-Farhat, in search for a traditional name, called his little empire of gambling and wrestling establishments "Ahlam's Temple". The enterprise grew and the Temple is now the most influential power in the system - constantly in skirmishes with the Consortium and the Syndicate.

SKAVARA

Semi-intelligent creatures called Skavara live in packs around human settlements. They are relative newcomers to the Algol system. Traders brought the snarling, badger-like Skavara from the Amedo system to Algol, where they multiplied in the shadow of humanity. In recent years, Ahlam's Temple has adopted Skavara and trained them to work as infiltrators. They are adept at moving about unseen, and can be found in the industrial areas around the big cities and in isolated mining colonies.

SLAVERS

Once a major faction in Algol (that was known throughout the Horizon for its slave markets), slavery has been declared immoral by the Alabaster Council. The Humanite Liberation set all semi-intelligents free. But that did not quench the thirst for slaves. Now, humans and humanits are captured and traded in the shadows. Some of the most notorious slavers have their home base in Algol.

ALGOLAN ECLIPSES

Because the stars Algol and Persei rotate around each other at a distance of less than 1 Astronomical Unit, the entire system is centered around the two stars shining together on the planet Algol. During the day, both stars are visible in the sky as two suns that quickly change position in the sky. Every third day, a solar eclipse occurs when one of the stars passes behind the other and is eclipsed by its partner's light.

On rare occasions, both suns are eclipsed by Algol's moon Barir, and then only Rhaas shines faintly in the sky - an occurrence that heralds misfortune and death. The last time this happened was just before The Age of Flaming Tears.

THE PLANET ALGOL

The planet Algol is the hub of the system and where the major population centers are located. Most people, city dwellers and rebels alike, live in the planet's two temperate bands. The planet's habitable zones are crowded by cities both old and new - including Yasul, Akhandar-O-Sharif, Belem, and Yousfana. These are surrounded by widespread wastelands. Colonies and mining operations exist across the entire planet and are common throughout the system - including on moons and asteroids, and in the Cloud Belt.

TABRIK'S LION

A rare phenomenon called Tabrik's Lion affects the portals in the Algol system. Astronics and Astrogators believe that due to the high speed at which Algol and Persei spin around each other, the stars form ball-shaped protuberances that seem to be drawn towards the portal fields. The name comes from the last words of the captain of the cruiser Tabrik, which disappeared as it left Algol after the planetary bombardment during the Portal Wars: "A lion, a lion - The Icons are with us".